

DAROUB

Al Marmoom and Al Qudra Lakes

A compact field guide

Dubai desert reserve and man-made lakes for birdwatching, cycling and regulated camping, with same-day checks on rules and weather.

Reference edition dated 2026-09-18

A concise Daroub guide based on the listed sources. The location is approximate, not a trailhead. Check current weather and local closures before leaving.

24.840, 55.352 | Asia/Dubai

Inside this book

- 01 Place and terrain
- 02 Equipment and preparation
- 03 Clothing and footwear
- 04 Access and transport
- 05 Season and conditions
- 06 Nature and identification limits
- 07 Visit precautions
- 08 Activity choice and booking
- 09 Rules and permits

01 Place and terrain

Visit Dubai places Al Qudra Lakes in the Al Marmoom reserve area, and Dubai Municipality lists the reserve in Dubai's protected-areas network. The map point is an approximate area marker, not a trailhead or guaranteed parking place; the image is illustrative. Check access on the day.

[Visit Dubai · Al Marmoom Desert Conservation Reserve](#)

[Visit Dubai · Al Qudra Lakes](#)

[Dubai Municipality · Digital platform for Dubai natural reserves network](#)

02 Equipment and preparation

Practical inference: because Visit Dubai describes lakes, desert activity and a cycle track, carry spare water, navigation, a charged phone and a light. For cycling, do not assume a bike or repair kit is available even where rentals and rest stops are mentioned; confirm operator hours before departure.

[Visit Dubai · Al Qudra Lakes](#)

[Visit Dubai · Al Qudra Cycle Track](#)

[National Center of Meteorology · UAE weather and forecasts](#)

03 Clothing and footwear

General advice, not a local requirement: use light-coloured clothing that covers skin, a hat and sunglasses, with a light layer for a longer evening stay. For sand, wear closed shoes; for cycling, use visible clothing and suitable gloves. Adjust the plan to NCM forecasts.

[Visit Dubai · Al Qudra Cycle Track](#)

[National Center of Meteorology · UAE weather and forecasts](#)

04 Access and transport

Visit Dubai says the reserve is easiest by car and that Al Qudra Lakes can be reached by regular car or 4×4 where sand is compacted near access areas. This is not permission to drive off-track; plan return transport and fuel, and avoid relying on one vehicle without a contact plan.

[Visit Dubai](#) · [Al Marmoom Desert Conservation Reserve](#)

[Visit Dubai](#) · [Al Qudra Lakes](#)

[Al Marmoom Ultramarathon](#) · [Our environment](#)

05 Season and conditions

Summer heat can change whether an activity is sensible. No fixed temperature threshold is given here; use the NCM forecast on the day, and favour early starts as the cycle-track page advises. Wind or dust can make birdwatching or riding unsuitable even under clear skies.

[Visit Dubai](#) · [Al Qudra Cycle Track](#)

[National Center of Meteorology](#) · [UAE weather and forecasts](#)

06 Nature and identification limits

The sources emphasise wildlife and birds around the lakes, and Dubai Municipality says the protected-areas platform covers species, habitats, monitoring and education. Identification limit: do not confirm a species from a photo or track alone; use binoculars and do not collect plants, sticks or rocks.

[Visit Dubai](#) · [Al Marmoom Desert Conservation Reserve](#)

[Visit Dubai](#) · [Al Qudra Lakes](#)

[Dubai Municipality](#) · [Digital platform for Dubai natural reserves network](#)

[Al Marmoom Ultramarathon](#) · [Our environment](#)

07 Visit precautions

Main hazards are exposure, heat, short-range disorientation and wildlife disturbance. Event rules state no feeding, no fires except designated areas, and no off-roading. Carry water and communications. In UAE emergencies call police 999, ambulance 998 or civil defence 997.

[UAE Government portal](#) · [Handling emergencies \(police 999, ambulance 998, civil defence 997\)](#)

[Al Marmoom Ultramarathon](#) · [Our environment](#)

[National Center of Meteorology](#) · [UAE weather and forecasts](#)

08 Activity choice and booking

Match the activity to ability: quiet birdwatching by the lakes, a short visit, riding on Al Qudra track, or regulated camping. The cycle-track page states 86 km of paths; you do not need to ride all of it. Confirm bookings, rentals and facility hours, and read signs on the day.

[Visit Dubai](#) · [Al Marmoom Desert Conservation Reserve](#)

[Visit Dubai](#) · [Al Qudra Lakes](#)

[Visit Dubai](#) · [Al Qudra Cycle Track](#)

09 Rules and permits

Documented practical rules: do not feed wildlife, do not take plants, sticks or rocks, do not drive outside designated areas, and do not light fires except in a designated area or suitable barbecue container. Drones require checking Dubai registration and permission. For camping, use allowed areas and check on the day.

[UAE Government portal](#) · [Handling emergencies \(police 999, ambulance 998, civil defence 997\)](#)

[Visit Dubai](#) · [Al Qudra Lakes](#)

[Al Marmoom Ultramarathon](#) · [Our environment](#)

[Dubai Civil Aviation Authority](#) · [Drone registration](#)

Wildlife & plants

Arabian oryx

[Information linked to regional sources](#)

Visit Dubai notes that oryx may be seen in natural habitat around the lakes in the reserve area. Treat sightings as possible, not promised, and watch from a distance.

Do not chase or feed it; move back if the animal changes behaviour or approaches a road.

[Visit Dubai](#) · [Al Qudra Lakes](#)

Desert fox

[Information linked to regional sources](#)

Visit Dubai lists foxes among wildlife that may be seen around Al Qudra Lakes. Encounters are usually brief; do not turn one into feeding or close photography.

Seal food and waste; foxes coming close usually means food management needs correcting.

[Visit Dubai](#) · [Al Qudra Lakes](#)

Flamingo

Information linked to regional sources

Visit Dubai mentions flamingos at the lakes and many bird species in the reserve area. Use binoculars and do not rely on a single season.

Stay on viewing edges and do not enter water or nesting areas; close approach spoils watching and disturbs birds.

[Visit Dubai](#) · [Al Marmoom Desert Conservation Reserve](#)

[Visit Dubai](#) · [Al Qudra Lakes](#)

Horned viper

Terrain example; not proof of presence at given coordinates

Dubai Municipality documents this species in another Dubai desert reserve; here it is a terrain example, not a confirmed record for Al Marmoom.

Do not put hands in holes or under stones, and use a light at night. If bitten, call ambulance services and avoid field treatment.

[UAE Government portal](#) · [Handling emergencies \(police 999, ambulance 998, civil defence 997\)](#)

[Dubai Municipality](#) · [Dubai Protected Area wildlife](#)

Desert scorpion

Terrain example; not proof of presence at given coordinates

The fetched sources did not give an official scorpion record for this exact place. This is a dry-sand terrain reminder, not a guaranteed presence.

Shake shoes and bedding before use, and do not walk barefoot near camp after sunset.

[Dubai Municipality](#) · [Dubai Protected Area wildlife](#)

Travel companions

A buddy-planning recommendation, not a safety guarantee. Remote or technical routes need group planning with a local expert. Avoid going alone.

Before you leave

Choose your route and turn-back point; check entry permissions and closures.

Check the forecast and save an offline map.

Review clothing, water, food and communication with your companions.

Agree a return time and alternative plan, and share them with a trusted contact.

Educational terrain examples, not a complete inventory or verified species list for these coordinates. Do not eat plants or animals based on this guide.

Sources and further reading

1. UAE Government portal · Handling emergencies (police 999, ambulance 998, civil defence 997)
<https://u.ae/en/information-and-services/justice-safety-and-the-law/Safety/handling-emergencies>
2026-09-18
2. Visit Dubai · Al Marmoom Desert Conservation Reserve
<https://www.visitdubai.com/en/places-to-visit/marmoom-reserve>
2026-09-18
3. Visit Dubai · Al Qudra Lakes
<https://www.visitdubai.com/en/places-to-visit/al-qudra-lakes>
2026-09-18
4. Visit Dubai · Al Qudra Cycle Track
<https://www.visitdubai.com/en/places-to-visit/al-qudra-cycling-track>
2026-09-18
5. Dubai Municipality · Digital platform for Dubai natural reserves network
<https://www.dm.gov.ae/digital-platform-for-dubais-natural-reserves-network-to-raise-community-awareness/>
2026-09-18
6. Dubai Municipality · Dubai Protected Area wildlife
<https://www.dm.gov.ae/dubai-protected-areas/wildlife/>
2026-09-18
7. Al Marmoom Ultramarathon · Our environment
<https://ultramarathon.ae/our-environment.php>
2026-09-18
8. National Center of Meteorology · UAE weather and forecasts
<https://www.ncm.gov.ae/?lang=en>
2026-09-18
9. Dubai Civil Aviation Authority · Drone registration
<https://www.dcaa.gov.ae/services/aviation-safety-operations/drone-registration/>
2026-09-18

Further guide from the official publisher

Al Marmoom Desert Conservation Reserve

A concise Daroub guide based on the listed sources. The location is approximate, not a trailhead. Check current weather and local closures before leaving.

daroub-terrain-guide.ifritliwa.chatgpt.site